

# WILLY (WEI-LI) CHEN

Old Botany Rm 5, Michigan State University| East Lansing, MI

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## EDUCATION

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**Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI**

*August 2022 – Present*

*Doctor of Philosophy - Economics*

- Peter Schmidt [Outstanding First-Year Student] Award

*Summer 2023*

**The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL**

*October 2019 – August 2020*

*Master of Arts in Social Sciences—Economics*

- Phoenix Research Award

- Director's Scholarship

**The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH**

*August 2015 – May 2019*

*Bachelor of Science in Mathematics—Theoretical*

*Bachelor of Science in Economics*

- Summa Cum Laude with Research Distinction in Economics

## TECHNICAL SKILLS AND RESEARCH INTERESTS

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- Data Analytics and Econometrics: Stata, R, Python, PostgreSQL, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X
- Languages: Fluent in English, Taiwanese, and Taiwanese Mandarin
- Interests: Economics of Inequality, Labor Economics

## PEER-REVEIWED PAPERS

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Elbel, B., Zhou, G. E., Lee, D. C., Chen, W., Day, S. E., Konty, K. J., & Schwartz, A. E. (2022). *Analysis of School-Level Vaccination Rates by Race, Ethnicity, and Geography in New York City*. JAMA network open, 5(9), e2231849-e2231849.

## WORKING PAPERS

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Chen, Willy and Qiao, Xiao and Zhang, Hanzhe, Over a Century of Economics Research Collaboration (May 21, 2025). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=5263564> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5263564>

Toossi, Saied and Schwartz, Amy Ellen and Chen, Willy, The Relationship between Entrée Variety and Student Participation in School Lunch (August 01, 2025). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=5378789> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5378789>

Willy Chen, October 2024.Chen, Willy, (Resubmitted) Descriptive Units of Heterogeneity: An Axiomatic Approach to Measuring Heterogeneity (July 23, 2024). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4952556> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4952556>

## EMPLOYMENT

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**Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI**

*August 2020 – Present*

*Assistant Manager—MSU Sailing Center (Summer 25')*

*Economics Course Instructor :*

- EC201—Introduction to Microeconomics (Spartan Early Start Session, Summer 25')

*Economics Courses Teaching Assistant:*

- EC251H/EC301—Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall 22', 24', 25'; Spring 26')

- EC812B—Graduate Game Theory (Spring 24', 25', 26')

*Economics Graduate Research Assistant:*

- Hanzhe Zhang (Fall 23'; Summer 24')

**Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY**  
*Research Associate, Center for Policy Research*

*September 2020 – May 2022*

**The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL**  
*Teaching Assistant, ECON 100/200/201*

*September 2019 – June 2020*

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY**  
*Research Associate – Center for Policy Research*

*September 2020 – Present*

- Supervising Professor: Amy Ellen Schwartz
- Statistical Analysis with multiple projects using student-level longitudinal data from New York City Department of Education and partnering organizations

**The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL**  
*Graduate Student Researcher, MA Thesis Project*

*October 2019 – August 2020*

- "Moving To Inclusion: The Migration Effects of Sanctuary City Policies"
- Handling proposal, research design, data collection, statistical analysis, and writing
- Conduct analysis at both the micro and the macro level, building on the random utility model and the Schelling Tipping point model

**The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH**  
*Undergraduate Student Researcher, BA Thesis Project*

*May 2017 – May 2019*

- "Fact Checking: An empirical analysis of the effect of sanctuary city policy"
- Cleaned and prepared raw data directly from the American Community Survey (ACS)
- Used city-year fixed-effect regressions under the *event studies* framework to analyze the city-level effect of sanctuary city policies in the United States

## REFERENCES

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**Name: (Dissertation Co-Chair) Todd Elder**  
Title: MSU Foundation Professor of Economics  
University: Michigan State University  
Email: telder@msu.edu  
Phone: 517-355-0353

**Name: (Dissertation Co-Chair) Hanzhe Zhang**  
Title: Associate Professor of Economics  
University: Michigan State University  
Email: hanzhe@msu.edu

**Name: Alfonso Flores-Lagunes** (Applied Econometrics Instructor)  
Title: Vice-President and Director of Research  
University: W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research  
Email: Flores-Lagunes@upjohn.org  
Phone: 269-716-4358